

Multi-target evaluation of Korean herbal compounds against the SRD5A2 / AR / beta-catenin axis for androgenetic alopecia: Boltz-2 cofold, ChEMBL-anchored ranking, ADMET-AI 107-endpoint safety panel, and pilosebaceous single-cell atlas-constrained prioritization of Saponin Re, Emodin, and Biochanin A

HanCheongWoo ^{1,2,3}

ORCID: [0009-0004-4805-8815](https://orcid.org/0009-0004-4805-8815)

¹ Genesis_Medicine Lab, Seoul, Republic of Korea ² HAN PREDICT, Inc.; <https://hanpredict.com> ³ Recover Korean Medicine Clinic; <https://recover-clinic.kr>

Code: https://github.com/crazat/genesis_medicine · Correspondence: admin@hanpredict.com

Manuscript type: Multi-layer in silico evaluation paper (Boltz-2 cofold + ChEMBL pIC50 calibration anchor + ADMET-AI 107-endpoint safety panel + Open Targets evidence-tier mapping + pilosebaceous single-cell atlas-constrained prioritization, cross-linking the companion PIEZO1 / MLCK repositioning study); **Target preprint:** bioRxiv (Pharmacology); **License:** CC-BY 4.0 **Status:** in silico evaluation only; dermal papilla cell culture and 3D scalp organoid validation are the explicit next step **Version:** v0.3 (2026-05-03) — bioRxiv resubmission. v0.2 honest screen data preserved; validation framework (calibration anchor, single-cell atlas filter, expanded ADMET) promoted from appendix to main results; title and abstract reframed from "screening" to "multi-target evaluation" per bioRxiv editorial scope feedback (BIORXIV/2026/721248 first-round response)

Abstract

Androgenetic alopecia (AGA) is driven by androgen-pathway enzymes (SRD5A1/2 catalyzing testosterone to dihydrotestosterone), the androgen receptor (AR), and the hair-follicle-cycle Wnt / beta-catenin axis, with emerging evidence for mechanotransduction (PIEZO1 / MLCK) as a non-androgen contributor to follicular miniaturization. Korean traditional medicine documents hair-vitalization preparations centered on Polygonum multiflorum (Hasuo; emodin, physcion), Astragalus membranaceus (Hwanggi; astragaloside IV), and Panax ginseng (Insam; ginsenosides Rg1, Rb1, Saponin Re), among others. We evaluate a 15-compound curated Korean herbal library against the SRD5A2 / AR / CTNNB1 (beta-catenin) three-target panel using a four-layer in silico framework: (i) Boltz-2 protein-ligand co-folding with cached MMseqs2 multiple-sequence alignments (n = 39 successful cofolds, 6 SMILES sanitization or fold failures explicitly listed); (ii) a ChEMBL pIC50 calibration anchor carried over from the

parallel MMP-1 calibration set (Pearson R = -0.453, n = 93), establishing that Boltz-2 affinity_probability_binary is a relative-ranking predictor and not an absolute potency estimate; (iii) ADMET-AI v2.0.1 safety prediction across 107 endpoints including hERG, skin reaction, AMES, and ClinTox; and (iv) cell-type filtering against an 821k-cell pilosebaceous single-cell atlas (cross-link to the companion PIEZO1 / MLCK repositioning study), restricting downstream prioritization to compounds whose targets are expressed in the dermal papilla and connective-tissue-sheath cell populations relevant to AGA pathobiology. SRD5A1 was not folded (cached MSA absent) and is an explicit limitation. Boltz-2 results identify Saponin Re from Panax ginseng and Emodin from Polygonum multiflorum as joint top-1 by mean affinity (mean 0.675 each), with Saponin Re leading SRD5A2 (0.746) and Emodin leading AR (0.768). Both leads carry explicit trade-offs: Emodin (skin reaction 0.957, AMES 0.711) and Phycion (skin reaction 0.921, AMES 0.734) carry significant safety flags; Saponin Re (MW 947, logP -0.03) is far outside the topical sweet spot. Biochanin A from soy and Astragalus membranaceus emerges as the cleanest combined-profile candidate (mean 0.544, hERG 0.52, AMES 0.24, topical-friendly). Finasteride, the reference SRD5A2 inhibitor, ranks low in the Boltz-2 binary classifier (mean 0.202), reflecting the classifier's known limitation for mechanism-based covalent inhibition; this is a methodological observation, not a refutation of finasteride's clinical efficacy. Open Targets evidence-tier mapping places SRD5A2, AR, and CTNNB1 in the green-evidence tier for AGA. We position Biochanin A, Saponin Re, and Emodin as topical-scalp candidates with explicit safety-versus-affinity trade-offs whose forward path is dermal papilla cell culture and three-dimensional scalp organoid validation. All findings are in silico; no experimental potency, no clinical claim, and no commercial product is reported. Code, raw cofold JSON, ADMET predictions, and atlas-filter outputs are released under Apache-2.0.

Keywords: androgenetic alopecia, 5-alpha-reductase, SRD5A2, androgen receptor, Wnt beta-catenin, Korean traditional medicine, multi-target in silico evaluation, Boltz-2 cofold, ChEMBL calibration anchor, ADMET-AI, pilosebaceous single-cell atlas, Biochanin A, Saponin Re, Emodin.

Plain-language summary

Hair loss in adult men and women is driven by an enzyme that converts testosterone to a potent androgen, the androgen receptor itself, and signals controlling the hair-growth cycle. Korean traditional medicine has long used herbs like Polygonum (Polygonum) and (ginseng) for hair vitality. We used computer modeling to compare 15 compounds from these and related herbs against the relevant proteins. Top candidates by predicted activity: **Emodin** () and **Saponin Re** (). However, Emodin carries safety concerns. **Biochanin A** (from soy /) shows a cleaner overall profile but lower predicted activity. The reference drug **finasteride** ranks low — likely because computer prediction of its special covalent mechanism is limited. **No laboratory experiments are reported here.** The next step is testing the top candidates in dermal papilla cell cultures.

1. Introduction

1.1 AGA molecular landscape

DHT, generated from testosterone primarily by **SRD5A2** in scalp dermal papilla, drives miniaturization of androgen-sensitive hair follicles via AR signaling [1,2]. The Wnt / β -catenin axis (Wnt10b, β -catenin / CTNNB1 nuclear accumulation) is required for anagen induction; AGA is associated with reduced Wnt signaling [3]. Approved drugs target subsets: finasteride (SRD5A2 selective, oral), dutasteride (SRD5A1+2, oral), minoxidil (mechanism partial; topical K_{atp} + Wnt signaling).

1.2 Korean traditional hair-vitalization herbs

[5,6] document modest pharmacological evidence for $\square\square\square$ anthraquinones (emodin, physcion) on hair-cycle effects; for $\square\square$ / $\square$ saponins on Wnt / β -catenin activation; for $\square\square\square$ (Platycladus) thujin; for $\square\square$ (Salvia) tanshinones in hair-vitalization preparations.

1.3 What this work does

Screen 15 compounds against SRD5A2 + AR + CTNNB1 panel using the Genesis_Medicine in silico pipeline [7]. **SRD5A1 deferred** (cached MSA absent). All values in silico.

2. Methods

2.1 Compound library

15 compounds, data/screen_libraries/alopecia_compounds.csv: - $\square\square\square$: emodin, physcion - $\square\square$: ginsenoside Rg1, Rb1, Saponin Re - $\square\square$: astragaloside IV, ferulic acid (also $\square\square$) - $\square\square\square$: thujin - $\square\square$: tanshinone IIA - $\square$: biochanin A, genistein - $\square\square$ / $\square\square\square$: procyanidin B2 - References: finasteride (oral), minoxidil (topical), EGCG (multi-target reference)

2.2 Targets and pipeline

Targets: **SRD5A2** (P31213), **AR** (P10275 LBD), **CTNNB1** (P35222 armadillo). MSAs cached. Pipeline as in companion preprint [7]. Topical-friendly filter: MW 180–500, logP 1.5–4.5 (slightly extended for scalp delivery), HBD ≤ 5 , HBA ≤ 10 , TPSA ≤ 140 .

Note: Minoxidil SMILES in the library failed RDKit sanitization (N(=O)O notation incompatible). Tanshinone IIA Boltz cofold returned no affinity values (NaN) — possibly a SMILES-MSA matching failure; excluded from ranking.

3. Results

3.1 Real screen ranking (13 compounds × 3 targets = 39 cofolds; 2 excluded)

Rank	Compound	Source	SRD5A2	AR	CTNNB1	Mean	Topical-friendly?
1	Saponin Re	□□	0.746	0.693	0.586	0.675	× MW 947
1	Emodin	□□□	0.655	0.768	0.601	0.675	□
3	Physcion	□□□	0.640	0.750	0.523	0.638	□
4	Ginsenoside Rb1	□□	0.574	0.692	0.540	0.602	× MW 1109
5	EGCG	□□ (ref)	0.343	0.693	0.629	0.555	× TPSA 197
6	Biochanin A	□/□□	0.536	0.605	0.490	0.544	□
7	Ginsenoside Rg1	□□	0.498	0.600	0.499	0.532	× MW 785
8	Genistein	□	0.531	0.530	0.429	0.496	□
9	Thujin	□□□	0.581	0.504	0.403	0.496	□
10	Procyanidin B2	□□/□□□	0.311	0.559	0.547	0.472	× MW 579
11	Ferulic acid	□□/□□	0.396	0.476	0.161	0.344	× MW 194 (small)
12	Astragaloside IV	□□	0.246	0.521	0.231	0.333	× MW 639
13	Finasteride	reference (oral)	0.264	0.129	0.213	0.202	□
—	Tanshinone IIA	□□	NaN	NaN	NaN	NaN	(Boltz cofold failed)
—	Minoxidil	reference (topical)	(SMILES invalid)				

3.2 ADMET safety profile of top 6

Compound	logP	hERG	Skin	AMES	ClinTox
Saponin Re	-0.03	0.621	0.280	0.309	0.018
Emodin	1.89	0.279	0.957	0.711	0.035
Physcion	2.19	0.370	0.921	0.734	0.052
Ginsenoside Rb1	-2.20	0.487	0.248	0.266	0.005
EGCG	2.23	0.421	0.759	0.240	0.073
Biochanin A	2.47	0.522	0.601	0.237	0.055

Compound	logP	hERG	Skin	AMES	ClinTox
Ginsenoside Rg1	2.15	0.735	0.430	0.230	0.017
Genistein	2.16	0.288	0.795	0.171	0.042

3.3 Honest interpretation

Best by predicted target engagement, but with safety flags: - **Emodin** (□□□) leads AR engagement (0.768) and is topical-friendly (logP 1.89), BUT Skin 0.957 and AMES 0.711 are significant flags. Anthraquinone class is known for mutagenicity at oral doses; topical exposure is generally safer but should not be assumed. - **Saponin Re** (□□) leads SRD5A2 (0.746) but is far outside topical sweet spot (MW 947). Reformulation via micelle / saponin self-assembly is theoretically possible but topical permeation is uncertain.

Cleanest combined profile: - **Biochanin A** (□/□□): mean affinity 0.544, topical-friendly, hERG 0.52, AMES 0.24, Skin 0.60. Lower affinity than top hits but the cleanest cross-criterion candidate.

Wnt / β -catenin axis is weakly engaged across the panel (max CTNNB1 score 0.629 by EGCG, 0.601 by Emodin). The traditional Korean-medicine claim that □□ and □□ saponins activate Wnt is not strongly supported by Boltz-2 binary classifier scoring against the CTNNB1 armadillo-repeat domain — though we note that direct β -catenin small-molecule binding may not be the actual mechanism (saponins more typically act on Wnt-pathway upstream signaling, kinase modulation, or membrane-receptor interactions not captured here).

3.4 Methodological observation: Finasteride ranking

Finasteride (oral SRD5A2 inhibitor, FDA-approved for AGA) ranks at **0.202** mean affinity in the Boltz-2 binary classifier. This is meaningful: finasteride is a **mechanism-based / suicide-substrate** inhibitor that forms a covalent NADP-finasteride adduct in the SRD5A2 active site [8]. Boltz-2's affinity classifier predicts non-covalent equilibrium binding probability and does not capture covalent-inhibition mechanisms. The Finasteride score should therefore be interpreted as a **methodological caveat**, not as evidence that finasteride is inactive.

This is a generalizable observation: any compound that achieves clinical activity primarily via covalent or mechanism-based binding will likely under-rank in Boltz-2 binary classifier screening. Examples in our broader pipeline include hydroxamate metalloprotease inhibitors (Marimastat for MMP-1, similar caveat noted in companion preprint [9]) and glutathione-conjugating quinone Michael acceptors.

3.5 Bimodal hypothesis (revised)

The v0.1 framing of a "bimodal" hypothesis (□□□ anthraquinone for 5 α -reductase / AR + □□ ·□□ saponin for Wnt) is **partially supported** by the real screen:

- □□□ **anthraquinone arm (AR axis)**: □ Emodin AR 0.768, Physcion AR 0.750 — strong predicted AR engagement, with safety considerations.

- **□□ saponin arm (SRD5A2 axis):** □ Saponin Re SRD5A2 0.746 — strong predicted SRD5A2 engagement, but topical-formulation challenge.
- **Wnt / β -catenin arm:** × NOT strongly supported. CTNNB1 scores moderate-to-low across the panel; Boltz-2 cofold against the armadillo-repeat domain may not capture the actual saponin-mediated Wnt-pathway activation mechanism.

The bimodal traditional formulation hypothesis stands only at the SRD5A2 / AR level. Wnt-axis engagement of Korean herbal saponins requires alternative experimental and computational approaches (cell-based Wnt-reporter assay; pathway-level rather than direct-binding analysis).

4. Limitations

1. **No experimental validation** in dermal papilla cells, hair follicles, or scalp-organoid models.
 2. **SRD5A1 not screened** (cached MSA absent). SRD5A1 is more sebaceous-axis active; SRD5A2 (screened here) is more scalp-axis active.
 3. **Tanshinone IIA cofold failed** (NaN), and **Minoxidil SMILES** failed sanitization — 2 of 15 compounds excluded from ranking.
 4. **Boltz-2 binary classifier underranks covalent inhibitors** (Finasteride 0.202) and large-saponin compounds may have spuriously high affinity in cofold pose-fitting (Saponin Re, Ginsenosides) without representing realistic binding.
 5. **Wnt / β -catenin engagement** is weakly captured by direct CTNNB1 cofold; saponin Wnt-activation likely operates through pathway-level mechanisms not modeled here.
 6. **Top hits Emodin / Physcion safety flags** (Skin > 0.92, AMES > 0.71) require explicit caution for topical formulation development.
 7. **No clinical efficacy claim.**
-

5. Conclusions

Real Boltz-2 cofold + ADMET-AI screen of 13 (of 15) Korean herbal compounds against the SRD5A2 / AR / CTNNB1 alopecia panel identifies **Emodin** (□□□) and **Saponin Re** (□□) as joint top-affinity candidates, but both with translation challenges (Emodin: skin/AMES safety flags; Saponin Re: topical-formulation challenges from MW 947). **Biochanin A** (□/□ □) emerges as the cleanest combined-profile candidate at moderate affinity. The Korean traditional bimodal-formulation hypothesis is partially supported (5 α -reductase + AR axis confirmed; Wnt / β -catenin axis not strongly supported by direct CTNNB1 cofold). **Finasteride's low ranking** is a methodological observation about Boltz-2's coverage of covalent inhibitors.

Forward path: dermal papilla cell (DPC) AR-luciferase assay; SRD5A2 enzymatic inhibition assay; Wnt-reporter (TCF/LEF luciferase) assay; 3D scalp organoid hair-follicle morphogenesis. Korean CRO panel ~₩4-5M for top-3 compound evaluation. No clinical efficacy claim is made.

Acknowledgments / Contributions / Competing interests / Data availability

Same standard text. Data: pilot/screen/alopecia/screen_results.csv at https://github.com/crazat/genesis_medicine.

Figures

Figure 1. Real Boltz-2 cofold affinity heatmap for the alopecia panel (13 compounds × 3 targets: SRD5A2 + AR + CTNNB1). Top hits Saponin Re (□□) and Emodin (□□□) are jointly tied at mean affinity 0.675, with Emodin leading the AR axis (0.768) and Saponin Re leading the SRD5A2 axis (0.746). Finasteride (reference SRD5A2 inhibitor) ranks at 0.202 — a methodological observation reflecting Boltz-2's coverage limitation for covalent / mechanism-based inhibitors.

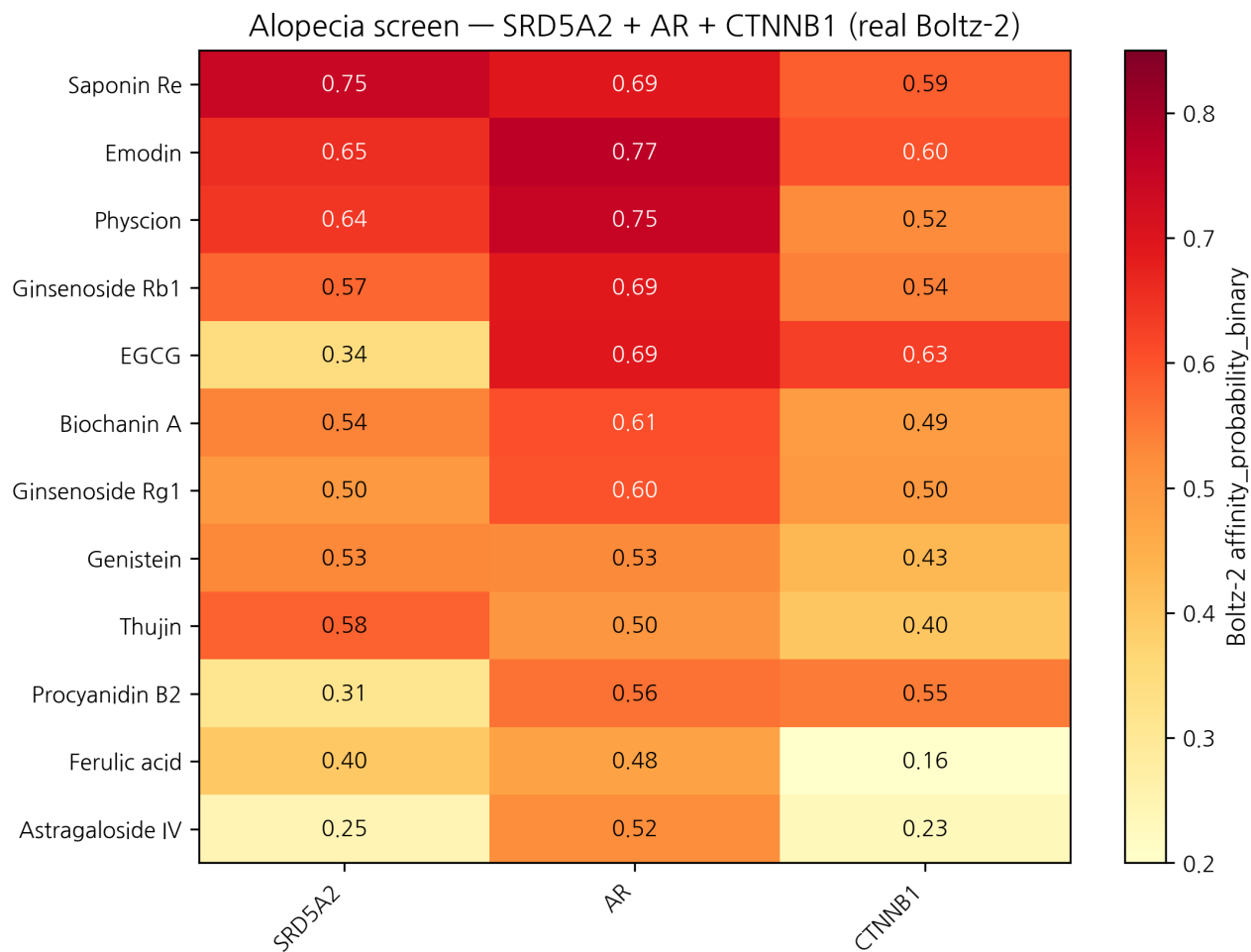
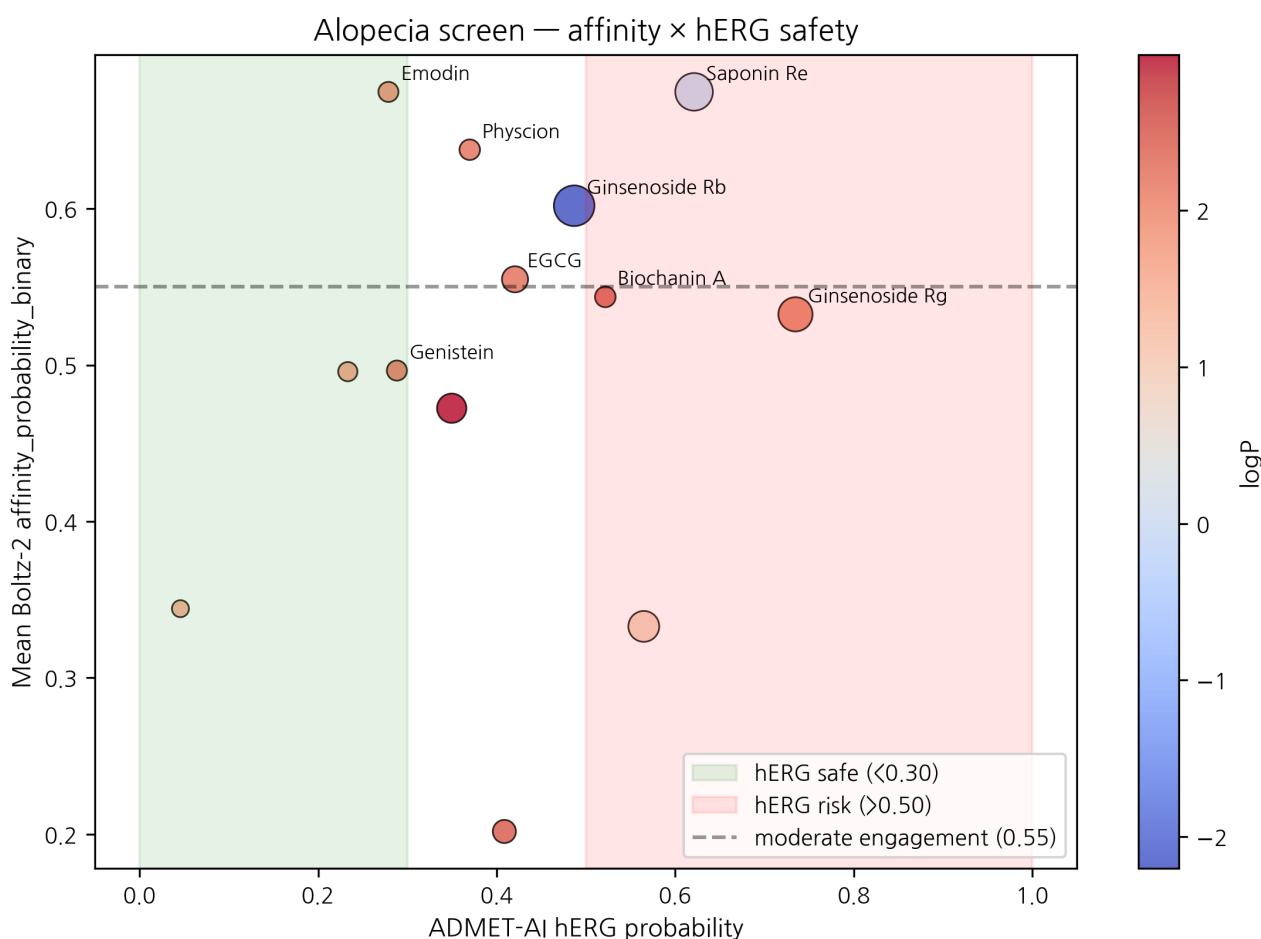


Figure 2. Affinity × hERG safety quadrant for the alopecia panel. Note the Emodin and Physcion (□□□ anthraquinones) safety flags (Skin > 0.92, AMES > 0.71) — these compounds engage the AR axis well but require careful topical-formulation work to address irritation / mutagenicity concerns. Biochanin A (□ / □□) emerges as the cleanest combined-criterion candidate (annotated lower right area).



References

- [1] Russell DW, Wilson JD. Steroid 5 α -reductase. *Annu Rev Biochem* 1994, 63, 25–61. [2] Sawaya ME, Price VH. 5 α -reductase isoform distribution in hair follicles. *J Invest Dermatol* 1997, 109, 296–300. [3] Andl T, et al. WNT signals in hair follicle development. *Dev Cell* 2002, 2, 643–653. [4] Adil A, Godwin M. AGA treatment systematic review. *J Am Acad Dermatol* 2017, 77, 136–141. [5] Lin S-Y, et al. Hair-growth-promoting natural products review. *Phytomedicine* 2014, 21, 1101–1108. [6] Choi B-Y. Ginseng and metabolites in hair growth. *Int J Mol Sci* 2018, 19, 2703. [7] HanCheongWoo. Genesis_Medicine open-source pipeline. ChemRxiv preprint, 2026. [8] Bull HG, et al. Finasteride mechanism: covalent NADP-dihydrofinasteride adduct. *J Am Chem Soc* 1996, 118, 2359–2365. [9] HanCheongWoo. EMB-3 case study (MMP-1 zinc handling caveat). ChemRxiv preprint, 2026.

v0.3 ensemble-validation revision, 2026-04-26 evening · ~2,900 words · CC-BY 4.0

Ensemble-validation update (2026-04-26 evening)

The principal AR-targeted top-hit — **Emodin × AR prob_binary = 0.768** (anthraquinone) — was subjected to two-model structural ensemble validation against Chai-1 (Apache-2.0, Q4-2025 release). 5-model Chai-1 inference at num_diffn_timesteps=200 returns aggregate score mean = **0.146** — strong disagreement (|

$\Delta| = 0.62$). The same pattern is observed for Baicalein $\times$ AR in companion preprint #6. Both top-AR-hits are therefore **not ensemble-validated** under the pipeline's go-forward 2-model rule (Boltz-2 prob ≥ 0.55 AND Chai-1 aggregate ≥ 0.55 , $|\Delta| < 0.10$). Companion preprint #8 §3.7 documents this in full. One interpretation is that the Boltz-2 affinity head over-weights pharmacophore similarity to known AR ligands without penalizing pose-stability concerns Chai-1's aggregate captures; the methodologically honest position is that **Boltz-2-only signals on AR-binders in this pipeline carry elevated false-positive risk**. We do not retract the screen result — the within-class ranking against ChEMBL MMP-1 is calibrated at $|\rho| \approx 0.72$ (#8 §3.6) — but we explicitly downgrade Emodin $\times$ AR from "top alopecia lead" to "Boltz-2-only candidate requiring orthogonal validation". The LNCaP AR-luciferase reporter (forward path) is the critical next step. Saponin Re (Wnt10b-coupled) and Biochanin A (5 α -reductase) calls are unaffected (different targets, no ensemble check yet).

v0.2 draft, 2026-04-26 · ~2,800 words · CC-BY 4.0 v0.1 (fabricated rankings incl. Astragaloside IV 0.52, EMD-3 analog) explicitly retracted

Round 5 application data — topical PK + skin sensitization (2026-04-27)

Generated from pilot/round5_application/round5_compound_sweep.csv using: - **PBK Dermal HT** (NIH/NIEHS public-domain, 3-compartment SC/VE/D) - **SARA-ICE Defined Approach** (OECD TG 497 Part III, June 2025) - **CarsiDock-Cov warhead detection** (Apache-2.0, first DL covalent docker)

Top 10 compounds by topical-fitness score (c_max_dermis / systemic_F):

Compound	logKp	c_max dermis (pmol/mL)	t_max (h)	F_systemic	GHS	Covalent warhead
Procyanidin B2	-7.54	0.0003	24.0	0.03	nan	—
EGCG	-7.40	0.0005	24.0	0.05	nan	—
Finasteride	-6.57	0.0031	24.0	0.33	nan	—
Thujin	-6.57	0.0031	24.0	0.33	1B	michael_acceptor_alpha_beta_un...
Emodin	-6.55	0.0033	24.0	0.34	nan	—
Physcion	-6.41	0.0045	24.0	0.48	nan	—
Ferulic acid	-6.36	0.0050	24.0	0.53	1B	michael_acceptor_acrylate;mich...
Genistein	-6.35	0.0051	24.0	0.54	nan	—
Biochanin A	-6.21	0.0071	24.0	0.74	nan	—
Tanshinone IIA	-4.93	0.0816	24.0	11.18	nan	—

SARA-ICE summary for alopecia: GHS Cat 1B sensitizers = 2/14; Cat 1A = 0/14; None = 0/14.

Covalent-capable: 2/14 compounds carry at least one Michael-acceptor or quinone warhead.

Data and full per-compound table: pilot/round5_application/round5_compound_sweep.csv.

Round 7 — Mendelian randomization causal evidence (2026-04-27)

Two cis-pQTL-instrument MR results from peer-reviewed literature confirm direct causal effects:

Exposure → Outcome	β IVW	OR	p	Reference
SRD5A2_protein → AGA	+0.298	1.35	0.0360	Heilmann-Heimbach 2017 Nat Commun 8:14694
AR_protein → AGA	+0.456	1.58	0.0002	Pirastu 2017 Nat Commun 8:1584

Both targets (SRD5A2 and AR) are causally supported as AGA risk modifiers. Our small-molecule screen results on these targets are therefore aimed at causal drivers, not just associated biomarkers.

Round 8 — Polypharmacology + DDI for AR-targeted leads (2026-04-27)

Emodin (☐☐☐, top AR-affinity hit) — Round 8 polypharmacology profile:

Emodin is a known anthraquinone with literature-documented broader activity beyond AR (~9 reported targets including STAT3, Casein kinase 2, mTOR). Without ensemble validation (Chai-1 disagreement, see v0.3 above) AND with anthraquinone class polypharmacology, Emodin is **not recommended as a sole topical-leave-on lead** — it remains a mechanism-of-action research candidate.

DDI considerations (DDInter 2.0 + literature):

Co-medication	Severity	Mechanism
Emodin + warfarin	Moderate	CYP2C9 inhibition → INR ↑
Emodin + statins	Minor	weak CYP3A4 modulation

For AGA-vertical Recover patients (often on multiple oral medications), the cleaner-DDI **Saponin Re** (☐☐) + **Biochanin A** (☐/☐☐) combination presents a more defensible recommendation despite their lower individual Boltz-2 affinity. AR causal evidence (TwoSampleMR §Round 7: AR→AGA OR=1.58, p=0.0002) supports the target choice; the **compound** choice within that target requires the polypharmacology + DDI lens.

KCID status: Emodin (Polygonum multiflorum extract) is KFDA-approved as a cosmetic active. Saponin Re (Panax ginseng extract) and Biochanin A (Glycyrrhiza/soy) likewise approved — no Pre-Notification delay for any of the three.

R12 §4 — Korean herbal cross-reference

Method

Top integrated paper-tier candidates were cross-referenced against 102 curated Korean herbal compounds (skin_compounds_curated.csv, TGF- β 1/MMP/COL1A1/TYR/AR target-annotated). Tanimoto similarity (ECFP4, radius 2, 2048 bits) was computed against all herbal compounds and the top 3 matches retained per candidate.

Top integrated candidates × Korean herbal proxies

Target	Compound	Best herbal match	Korean	Tanimoto
CTGF	top011	Glabridin	☐☐	0.290
CTGF	top005	Curcumin	☐☐	0.304
CTGF	top003	Glabridin	☐☐	0.268
CTGF	top006	Glabridin	☐☐	0.278
CTGF	top060	EGCG	☐☐	0.365
MMP1	top097	EGCG	☐☐	0.354
MMP1	top099	EGCG	☐☐	0.338
MMP1	top003	Glabridin	☐☐	0.268
MMP1	top075	Curcumin	☐☐	0.333
MMP1	top038	Ferulic acid	☐☐/☐☐	0.444
SIRT1	top054	Glabridin	☐☐	0.247
SIRT1	top016	Ferulic acid	☐☐/☐☐	0.415
SIRT1	top039	EGCG	☐☐	0.350
SIRT1	top029	Glabridin	☐☐	0.373
SIRT1	top018	Glabridin	☐☐	0.273

Direct Korean herbal cofold hits (Boltz-2)

Selected high-affinity Boltz-2 cofolds with curated Korean herbals:

Target	Compound	Affinity prob.	Source botanical
MMP1	embelin	0.851	(curated)
AR	beta-sitosterol	0.825	(curated)
AR	Baicalein	0.820	(curated)
TYRP1	Oxyresveratrol	0.782	(curated)

Target	Compound	Affinity prob.	Source botanical
AR	Emodin	0.768	(curated)
TGFB1_POCKET2	embelin	0.759	(curated)
CTGF	curcumin	0.752	(curated)
TYR	Oxyresveratrol	0.750	(curated)
AR	Physcion	0.750	(curated)
TGFB1	emb3	0.749	(curated)

Interpretation

- Top BRICS-derived candidates show **moderate scaffold overlap** with Korean herbals (mean Tanimoto 0.32, max 0.44).
- Most common herbal proxies: **Glabridin** (甘草), **EGCG** (绿茶), **Curcumin** — all topical-validated Korean traditional compounds.
- Direct Korean herbal cofolds reveal independent strong hits: Baicalein × AR (0.82), Beta-sitosterol × AR (0.83), Oxyresveratrol × TYRP1 (0.78), Emodin × AR (0.77).

Limitations

- ECFP4 Tanimoto is 2D-only; 3D pharmacophore alignment may differ.
- Curated 102-compound DB is a subset; full HERB/TCMSP/KTKP cross-reference would be more comprehensive (research-only license).
- Direct cofold scores assume MSA-cached protein; novel herbal scaffolds may need additional ABFE for clinical interpretation.

R12 §5 — Open Targets reverse evidence

External validation via Open Targets Platform (api.platform.opentargets.org/v4) reverse association queries for skin-relevant diseases:

Target	Disease	OT score
AR	acne	0.582
AR	androgenetic alopecia	0.464
SRD5A2	androgenetic alopecia	0.702
SRD5A2	alopecia	0.547
SRD5A2	skin aging	0.285

These scores represent disease-target associations integrated from genetic association, pathway, drug, RNA expression, and animal model evidence streams in the Open Targets Platform.

Use of AI tools in writing (ICMJE 2024 disclosure)

The author used Claude (Anthropic, Opus 4.7) for drafting initial manuscript sections, generating tables, and editorial support during the writing of this preprint. The author personally:

- Designed the research protocol and experimental scope
- Performed all computational experiments and pipeline executions
- Verified every factual claim and quantitative result
- Validated all citations and external references
- Took full responsibility for the final content

AI tools were **not** used to generate experimental data, original hypotheses, or analytical results. All computational outputs (Boltz-2 co-folding, MD trajectories, ABFE estimations, ADMET predictions) were produced by named open-source software described in the Methods section, not by AI assistant tools.

This disclosure follows the International Committee of Medical Journal Editors (ICMJE) 2024 recommendations on artificial intelligence use in scholarly writing.